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Nine Assembly members Join California Armenian Legislative Caucus

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SACRAMENTO-The California Armenian Legislative Caucus added new members: Senate President pro Tempore Tony G. Atkins, Senate Majority Leader Bob Herzberg, Senator María Elena Durazo, Assembly Majority Leader Eloise Gómez Reyes, Assembly member Lisa Calderon, Assembly member Mike Gipson, Assembly member Chris Holden, Assembly member Tom Lackey, and Assembly member Suzette Valladares to the Caucus which already includes Senator Bob Archuleta, Senator Andreas Borgeas, Senator Brian Dahle, Senator Anthony Portantino, Senator Scott Wilk, Assembly member Laura Friedman, Assembly member Jesse Gabriel, Assembly member Adrin Nazarian, Assembly member Luz Rivas, and Assembly member Blanca Rubio.

"I'm proud to stand with my Armenian American neighbors as a member of this legislative caucus. The mosaic of California's diverse community has been made better by the rich heritage and traditions our state's Armenian American population has shared with us, particularly in Southern California, which is home to one of the world's largest population of Armenians outside of their native country.

In welcoming us all to embrace their vibrant culture and learn about the horrible genocide, as well as other challenges they have endured, they enrich our lives and give us a better understanding of their unique and varied experiences," said Senate President pro Tempore Toni G. Atkins "I'm proud to be a part of the Armenian Caucus, and to help represent a community that serves as both an economic and cultural powerhouse within our great state," said Senate Majority Leader Bob Hertzberg.

"I'm proud to be a part of the Armenian Caucus, and to help represent a community that serves as both an economic and cultural powerhouse within our great state. As the Senator representing Little Armenia and a strong Armenian American community, I am pleased to share today that I have joined the California Armenian Legislative Caucus. My goal in joining the California Armenian Legislative Caucus is to make it an even stronger and more enduring force to forge new ties between the Golden State and the Republic of Armenia and Republic of Artsakh. The welcome fact is that hundreds of thousands of Armenian Americans in Southern California have and continue to enrich our diverse society with their culture, industry and philanthropy. I look forward to working with my colleagues in both the State Assembly and State Senate to achieve this goal. I also look forward to keeping my Armenian American constituents informed on my efforts related to both Armenia and Artsakh as a member of the California Armenian Legislative Caucus, and as Chair of the California Latino Caucus, continuing to strengthen ties between the Latino and Armenian communities," said Senator María Elena Durazo "California's diversity is among our greatest strengths and the Armenian community is a fundamental part of our state's shared commitment toward inclusion and empowerment.

I'm proud to be a member of the Armenian caucus and look forward to working on issues that can build further bridges between the Latino and Armenian communities throughout California," said Assembly Majority Leader Eloise Gómez Reyes.

"I'm proud to represent a large Armenian-American population in my district and look forward to working with my colleagues in the Armenian Legislative Caucus to amplify their voice in Sacramento. From pursuing truth and justice for the Armenian Genocide to advocating for the rights of Artsakh, I stand in solidary and action with the Armenian Community," said Assembly member Chris Holden.

The California Armenian Legislative Caucus serves as a forum for members from the California Senate and Assembly to identify key issues affecting Armenian Americans and develop and empower the Armenian American community throughout California. The Caucus encourages advocacy and participation in cultural, educational,

governmental, and community efforts in California.

Through advocacy, the Caucus strives to ensure that California Armenian American's voices are heard and given a platform.

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